

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION

CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27

SET B — ADVANCED HOTS & ANALYTICAL THINKING**CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-B-06

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET B - Advanced HOTS & Analytical Thinking):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS) Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed to test **deep causal reasoning, critical source evaluation, constitutional mechanics, and economic analysis**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **ADVANCED HOTS INSTRUCTIONS:** Carefully analyze the socio-historical contexts, geomorphic cause-and-effect relationships, and constitutional principles before selecting your answer.

Q.1 Why is the mere holding of regular periodic elections insufficient to qualify a country as a genuine democracy?

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| (A) Elections can be rigged, political opposition can be suppressed, and real state power may remain concentrated in unelected military or oligarchic institutions | (B) Because elections are prohibited under international democratic charters |
| (C) True democracies never allow citizens to vote in elections | (D) Because only monarchies hold national periodic elections |

Q.2 What is the analytical distinction between 'Procedural Democracy' and 'Substantive Democracy'?

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| (A) Procedural democracy focuses on formal mechanisms like regular elections; substantive democracy ensures genuine socio-economic equality, human dignity, and effective empowerment of all citizens | (B) Procedural democracy is practiced only in prisons; substantive democracy applies only to armies |
| (C) Procedural democracy bans all voting; substantive democracy mandates military rule | (D) There is no distinction; both terms refer to absolute monarchy |

Q.3 How does an independent judiciary uphold the 'Rule of Law' in a constitutional democracy?

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| (A) It possesses the power of Judicial Review to strike down executive decrees and legislative statutes that violate fundamental constitutional rights | (B) It blindly executes whatever orders the ruling Prime Minister issues without questioning |
| (C) It cancels all national elections permanently to prevent political debates | (D) It acts as the personal private security guard of cabinet ministers |

Q.4 In his concluding address to the Constituent Assembly on 25 November 1949, what fundamental contradiction in India's emerging democratic life did Dr. B.R. Ambedkar articulate?

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| (A) We are entering a life of contradictions: in politics we will have equality (one person, one vote), but in social and economic life we will continue to have deep inequality | (B) He warned that India should immediately abolish the Constitution and restore British colonial rule |
| (C) He argued that poor citizens should never be permitted to vote in elections | (D) He claimed that all human beings are identical in biological physical strength |

Q.5 Why did Nobel laureate Amartya Sen argue that no major famine has ever occurred in a functioning, independent democracy with a free press?

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| <p>(A) Democratic governments face imminent electoral defeat and hostile press scrutiny if they fail to provide prompt famine relief, compelling rapid public action</p> | <p>(B) Democracies never experience failure of seasonal rainfall or droughts</p> |
| <p>(C) Democratic nations produce unlimited food grain without farming</p> | <p>(D) Dictatorships have no human population to feed</p> |

Q.6 How does the principle of 'Majoritarianism' differ from and potentially threaten 'Constitutional Democracy'?

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| <p>(A) Majoritarianism asserts that a numerical majority can dictate all policies regardless of minority rights; constitutional democracy imposes legal boundaries to protect minority liberties</p> | <p>(B) Majoritarianism guarantees equal rights to all minorities, while constitutional democracy abolishes them</p> |
| <p>(C) Majoritarianism is practiced only in small rural schools</p> | <p>(D) There is no conflict; majoritarian rule is the only rule recognized by constitutional law</p> |

Q.7 Under General Pervez Musharraf in Pakistan (1999–2002), elections were held for national and provincial assemblies, but why did political scientists classify the regime as NON-DEMOCRATIC?

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| <p>(A) Under the Legal Framework Order, supreme executive authority was retained by the President and the military-dominated National Security Council, overriding elected lawmakers</p> | <p>(B) Elections were conducted with paper ballots instead of computers</p> |
| <p>(C) Candidates were required to hold university degrees</p> | <p>(D) The assembly met only during nighttime hours</p> |

Q.8 Why is freedom of speech and expression (Article 19 in the Indian Constitution) considered the lifeblood of democratic governance?

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| <p>(A) It permits citizens and journalists to critique state policies, expose administrative corruption, propose policy alternatives, and hold powerful officials accountable</p> | <p>(B) It gives citizens the legal right to incite communal violence without consequence</p> |
| <p>(C) It requires all citizens to praise the ruling government daily on radio</p> | <p>(D) It forces newspapers to publish only government-approved advertising</p> |

Q.9 How does democratic deliberation improve the quality of legislative policymaking compared to authoritarian decision-making?

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| <p>(A) Deliberation subjects proposals to multi-stakeholder scrutiny, parliamentary committee debates, and public consultation, catching fatal flaws before implementation</p> | <p>(B) Deliberation ensures that decisions are made in less than ten seconds</p> |
| <p>(C) Deliberation eliminates the need for written laws and courts</p> | <p>(D) Deliberation ensures that only one person makes all national choices</p> |

Q.10 Why was the electoral system of the Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) in Mexico (1930–2000) deemed non-democratic despite six-decade multi-party elections?

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| <p>(A) The ruling party monopolized state funds, compelled public school teachers and civil servants to campaign, biased television media, and shifted polling booths unfairly</p> | <p>(B) The party did not allow anyone over 20 years old to vote</p> |
| <p>(C) Mexico had no currency to fund election campaigns</p> | <p>(D) The country was an absolute monarchy ruled by a royal king</p> |

Q.11 What democratic dilemma arises when a wealthy individual can spend billions of rupees on political campaigns while an impoverished citizen can spend nothing?

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| <p>(A) It violates political equality, as disproportionate financial power allows wealthy elites to capture candidate selection, media access, and policy priorities</p> | <p>(B) It proves that rich citizens have ten votes while poor citizens have zero</p> |
| <p>(C) It demonstrates that poverty has zero connection to democratic politics</p> | <p>(D) It has no impact because money cannot purchase advertising in modern media</p> |

Q.12 How does a democratic federal structure accommodate deep regional, cultural, and linguistic diversity in a country like India?

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| <p>(A) By constitutionally distributing sovereign legislative and executive powers between the Union and the States, enabling regional autonomy within national unity</p> | <p>(B) By declaring all regional languages illegal and imposing one dialect by military force</p> |
| <p>(C) By abolishing all state governments and concentrating all power in New Delhi</p> | <p>(D) By expelling diverse cultural groups beyond national borders</p> |

Q.13 Why is the presence of an autonomous, legally protected political opposition indispensable for the health of a democracy?

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| <p>(A) It holds the government accountable, scrutinizes administrative budgets, presents alternative policy manifestos, and offers voters a viable alternative government</p> | <p>(B) It allows the ruling party to arrest all critics without warrants</p> |
| <p>(C) It ensures that bills are passed without any parliamentary discussion</p> | <p>(D) It assists the military in carrying out unconstitutional coups</p> |

Q.14 What is the primary danger of a 'winner-takes-all' zero-sum conception of democratic politics?

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| <p>(A) It incentivizes defeated political factions to subvert constitutional rules, polarizes society, and treats political rivals as existential enemies rather than legitimate opponents</p> | <p>(B) It ensures that everyone receives free government housing immediately</p> |
| <p>(C) It leads to the total elimination of all political parties</p> | <p>(D) It forces all citizens to live in rural farming villages</p> |

Q.15 How does the Right to Information (RTI Act, 2005) deepen democratic citizenship in India?

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| <p>(A) It legally empowers ordinary citizens to inspect government files, demand copies of official records, and expose corruption, reversing bureaucratic secrecy</p> | <p>(B) It allows the government to read every citizen's personal private diary</p> |
| <p>(C) It bans all journalists from writing about politics</p> | <p>(D) It allows civil servants to work without keeping written records</p> |

Q.16 Why do critics argue that frequent changes of government in coalition democracies can sometimes hinder long-term economic development?

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| <p>(A) Fragile multi-party coalitions can produce policy paralysis, frequent populist appeasement, and reluctance to take necessary long-term structural decisions</p> | <p>(B) Coalition governments always declare war on their own citizens</p> |
| <p>(C) Coalition governments abolish all taxation permanently</p> | <p>(D) Frequent elections cause the earth's climate to warm up</p> |

Q.17 What mechanism ensures that the fundamental rights of citizens are protected against arbitrary changes by a temporary legislative majority?

- (A) The 'Basic Structure Doctrine' formulated by the Supreme Court in *Kesavananda Bharati* (1973), which limits Parliament's constitutional amending power
- (B) A decree signed by the Secretary-General of the United Nations
- (C) A public referendum held every Friday afternoon
- (D) There is no mechanism; any parliamentary majority can abolish human rights at will

Q.18 In a democratic school classroom, what pedagogical approach best reflects democratic values?

- (A) Encouraging open student debate, critical questioning of texts, collaborative decision-making, and respecting diverse intellectual opinions
- (B) The teacher punishing students who ask questions or express different viewpoints
- (C) Requiring students to memorize textbooks without understanding their meaning
- (D) Deciding exam grades by physical arm-wrestling matches

Q.19 How does the principle of 'Universal Adult Franchise' serve as a powerful engine of social egalitarianism in a historically hierarchical society like India?

- (A) It gives the vote of a landless Dalit agricultural laborer identical constitutional weight to the vote of a billionaire industrialist or feudal landlord
- (B) It allows only university professors to cast votes in national elections
- (C) It forces all citizens to wear identical uniform clothing
- (D) It eliminates all economic differences between citizens overnight

Q.20 Why is freedom of peaceful assembly and protest considered an essential democratic right alongside voting?

- (A) Voting happens only once every five years; peaceful protest allows citizens to continuously communicate grievances and check executive overreach between elections
- (B) Protests are designed exclusively to overthrow democratic constitutions
- (C) Peaceful protest is legally required before every citizen eats dinner
- (D) Protest eliminates the need to hold legislative assembly elections

Q.21 Which international standard distinguishes a legitimate democratic referendum from an authoritarian plebiscite?

- (A) A free campaign environment with equal media access, impartial phrasing of ballot questions, secret voting, and absence of police intimidation
- (B) A voter turnout of exactly 100.0% announced by the military within 10 minutes
- (C) The complete absence of international observers and media cameras
- (D) Holding the referendum while opposition leaders are detained in prison

Q.22 How does the concept of 'Civil Society' function as an intermediary buffer in a democratic nation?

- (A) It comprises non-governmental organizations, trade unions, self-help groups, and resident welfare associations that articulate public interests independent of the state
- (B) It is a specialized branch of the armed military police force
- (C) It is a commercial cartel of private corporate banks
- (D) It represents foreign diplomats living in embassies

Q.23 Why is decentralized local governance (Panchayati Raj institutions under the 73rd Amendment) considered vital for deepening democracy in India?

- (A) It brings decision-making directly to the grassroots village level (*Gram Sabha*), fostering participatory budgeting and empowering women through 33% reservations
- (B) It allows state governors to dismiss village sarpanches without hearings
- (C) It forces all village residents to move into metropolitan high-rise apartments
- (D) It replaces all national courts with military courts

Q.24 What is the fundamental flaw of an unelected technocracy (rule by appointed technical experts alone) compared to democratic governance?

- (A) Technocrats lack electoral accountability to citizens, can become detached from human ethical values, and may impose harsh economic pain without democratic consent
- (B) Technocrats have no knowledge of mathematics or engineering
- (C) Technocrats refuse to read books or conduct scientific research
- (D) Technocratic governance is legally required by all international treaties

Q.25 In conclusion, why does Winston Churchill's famous maxim describe democracy as 'the worst form of government except for all those other forms that have been tried'?

- (A) Democracy is messy, slow, and imperfect, but it is the only system that protects human freedom, checks tyranny, and enables peaceful self-correction without bloodshed
- (B) Democracy guarantees that human society will collapse into chaos
- (C) All non-democratic systems are morally superior to democracy
- (D) Democracy was invented to destroy all human scientific progress

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET B)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
06 (A) (B) (C) (D)	07 (A) (B) (C) (D)	08 (A) (B) (C) (D)	09 (A) (B) (C) (D)	10 (A) (B) (C) (D)
11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET B)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Procedural elections can mask authoritarian control (as in Mugabe's Zimbabwe or PRI's Mexico); substantive democracy requires free competition, civil liberties, and institutional checks.
Q.2	(A)	Procedural democracy satisfies ballot-box rituals; substantive democracy achieves real democratic equality, safeguarding minorities, social justice, and citizen voice.
Q.3	(A)	Judicial review ensures that no state organ transcends constitutional limits, protecting citizen rights from majoritarian or executive tyranny.
Q.4	(A)	Ambedkar warned that political democracy (formal one-vote equality) would collapse if social and economic inequalities (caste, wealth concentration) were not dismantled.
Q.5	(A)	Sen's entitlement theory proves that famines stem from distribution failures; democratic accountability and free media force governments to mobilize relief before mass starvation occurs.
Q.6	(A)	Majoritarian tyranny tramples minority civil liberties; constitutional democracy bounds majority rule by entrenched fundamental rights and the rule of law.
Q.7	(A)	A regime cannot be democratic if elected representatives lack ultimate decision-making power and remain subordinate to an unelected military executive.
Q.8	(A)	Free speech enables public deliberation, peaceful protest, investigative journalism, and democratic accountability, preventing authoritarian information suppression.
Q.9	(A)	While democratic consultation takes time, multi-perspective debate surfaces unintended consequences, improves compliance, and prevents catastrophic unilateral blunders.
Q.10	(A)	The PRI's systemic abuse of state apparatus, control over media, coercion of public employees, and electoral engineering eliminated fair competition, denying genuine choice.
Q.11	(A)	Unregulated plutocratic campaign spending distorts the democratic norm of political equality, transforming formal democracy into an elite oligarchy.
Q.12	(A)	Democratic federalism (Seventh Schedule Union/State/Concurrent lists, linguistic states reorganization) accommodates regional aspirations while preserving national integrity.
Q.13	(A)	Without a viable, protected opposition, electoral competition becomes illusory, enabling ruling incumbents to entrench authoritarian power without checks.
Q.14	(A)	When political victory is viewed as absolute and defeat as catastrophic, political tolerance erodes, leading to constitutional backsliding and hyper-polarization.
Q.15	(A)	RTI empowers sovereign citizens to breach colonial administrative secrecy, holding civil servants accountable for public fund expenditures and welfare delivery.
Q.16	(A)	Coalition vulnerabilities may foster short-term opportunistic bargaining and policy instability, though they also promote consensual broad-based representation.
Q.17	(A)	The Basic Structure doctrine bars Parliament from using Article 368 to amend core pillars of the Constitution, including democracy, secularism, judicial review, and fundamental rights.
Q.18	(A)	Democratic education cultivates critical inquiry, mutual respect, empathetic dialogue, and collaborative reasoning rather than authoritarian indoctrination.
Q.19	(A)	Universal adult suffrage grants radical dignity: at the polling booth, feudal hierarchies dissolve as every adult citizen wields an identical franchise.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Democratic politics is an ongoing dialogic process; peaceful public protest channels citizen feedback and checks state arbitrary power between election cycles.
Q.21	(A)	Authoritarian plebiscites use coercive intimidation and rigged choices to rubber-stamp dictators; democratic referendums guarantee free debate and secret balloting.
Q.22	(A)	Civil society associations mobilize citizen concerns, provide disaster relief, advocate for marginalized communities, and check state and market abuses.
Q.23	(A)	Grassroots devolution institutionalizes direct participatory democracy, enabling rural citizens to prioritize drinking water, sanitation, and school investments locally.
Q.24	(A)	While technical expertise is essential, public policy choices involve moral values, equity trade-offs, and democratic legitimacy that only elected representatives can balance.
Q.25	(A)	Churchill noted that despite human shortcomings, procedural squabbles, and slow deliberations, democracy alone secures human dignity and self-repairing liberties.